

Every programmer has a preferred method for doing so. Even so, Python projects follow conventions for folder names and hierarchies. Your simpler programs might consist of a single `.py` file. But as you tackle more sophisticated projects, you'll start to include additional `.py` files, data files, documentation, unit tests, and more. Typically, the root of the project folder contains a `src` folder for the `.py` source code files, a `tests` folder for unit tests, and a `docs` folder for any documentation (such as those generated by the Sphinx documentation tool). Other files contain project information and tool configuration: `README.md` for general information, `.coveragerc` for code coverage configuration, `LICENSE.txt` for the project's software license, and so on. These tools and files are beyond the scope of this book, but they're worth investigating. As you gain more coding experience, re-creating the same basic files for new programming projects becomes tedious. To speed up your coding tasks, you can use the `cookiecutter` Python module to create these files and folders automatically. You'll find the full documentation for both the module and the Cookiecutter command line program at <https://cookiecutter.readthedocs.io/>.

To install Cookiecutter, run `pip install --user cookiecutter` (on Windows) or `pip3 install --user cookiecutter` (on macOS and Linux). This installation includes the Cookiecutter command line program and the `cookiecutter` Python module. The output might warn you that the command line program is installed to a folder not listed in the `PATH` environment variable:

```
Installing collected packages: cookiecutter
  WARNING: The script cookiecutter.exe is installed in
'C:\Users\Al\AppData\Roaming\Python\Python38\Scripts' which is not on PATH.
  Consider adding this directory to PATH or, if you prefer to suppress this
warning, use --no-warn-script-location.
```

Consider adding the folder (`C:\Users\Al\AppData\Roaming\Python\Python38\Scripts` in this case) to the `PATH` environment variable by following the instructions in “Environment Variables and PATH” on page 35. Otherwise, you'll have to run Cookiecutter as a Python module by entering `python -m cookiecutter` (on Windows) or `python3 -m cookiecutter` (on macOS and Linux) instead of simply `cookiecutter`.